SOMEWHERE BETWEEN US

我們之間

TART & TINE

Animated short screenplay

English action · Traditional Chinese Cantonese dialogue

Continuity revision · 14 October 2026

Based on the original story outline by Irene Chan

Approximate story target: 20 minutes before credits

CHARACTERS AND CONTINUITY

TART / 蛋撻

Pale cream Labrador with warm beige ears and no heart marking. Original puppy and adult designs retained. Working: brown leather guide harness, silver handle, brown grip and brown collar; NO collar lead attached. At home: collar only. At the harbour: Ah Ming sits, removes the harness, then clips the brown lead onto the collar and holds it throughout play.

TINE / 阿華田

Chestnut Labrador with the established cream heart marking on the same rump side. Original puppy and adult designs retained. Adult visiting outfit: orange bandanna with established emblem, separate orange collar and lead. Lead clips to the collar, never the bandanna.

AH MING / 阿明

Tart's blind owner. Preserve original dark-glasses, teal-jacket design. Independent route decisions; white folding cane available in his navy bag. Records only while stationary. Headphones only for seated editing at home.

MAY / 阿 May

Tine's handler. Preserve original sage-shirt design. Tan visiting bag, sage mat, cream water bottle with teal cap and clipped teal collapsible bowl. Carries ONE captioned puppy print; no saved puppy-phone image or separate history-folder insert.

UNCLE CHAN / 陳伯

Widowed, living independently. Preserve original cardigan design. Navy tote, beige sunhat, wallet, tissues and water. His wife and village dog Ah Wong / 阿黃 appear in one separate old photograph.

BO / 阿寶

Female centre worker, teal polo, dark trousers, short bob and lanyard. She organises the listening activity and outing. A second male colleague in a slate polo accompanies the group.

LOK / 阿樂 AND MOTHER

School-age boy in mustard top and navy shorts, with his mother in a blue blouse. She accompanies him throughout.

AUNTIE LAN / 蘭姐

Worker at Lan Kee Cha Chaan Teng / 蘭記茶餐廳 in Central. Coral blouse, dark green apron. Knows both pairs.

01 | EXT. PUPPY PLAY AREA, VICTORIA, AUSTRALIA - MORNING

Grass brushes a low timber bench. A soft, two-ended squeaky toy lies beneath it. Beyond the fence, open pasture. A handler watches the puppies from the gate.

BABY TART, a pale cream Labrador, lowers his head and studies the gap.

BABY TINE, chestnut brown with a pale heart-shaped patch on his rump, arrives at speed. He squeezes under the bench. His mouth reaches the toy; his bottom cannot follow the turn.

Two hind paws shuffle backwards. Tine emerges without the toy, one ear inside out.

Tart walks around the bench. He stretches a foreleg through the wider gap and nudges the toy towards Tine.

Tine pounces. SQUEAK.

Both puppies hop back. The toy lies perfectly still.

Tart stretches his nose towards it. Tine stretches his nose towards Tart's nose. They almost touch.

Tart presses one paw down. SQUEAK.

Tine drops into an enormous play bow. Tart answers with a small, exact one.

They take opposite ends. Tart plants his paws. Tine shuffles for a better grip, shuffles once too far and sits down.

The toy slips free. Tart stands with his prize. Tine's tail sweeps the grass.

Tart turns as if to leave. Stops. Brings the free end back.

Tine springs up. They run around the bench: Tart close to the legs, Tine taking a wide, exuberant bend through a shallow water bowl.

Tine stops to examine his wet paw. Shakes it. Tries the other paw. Tart waits with the toy until Tine remembers the game.

A few raindrops darken the timber. The handler opens the shelter door. While she gathers the other puppies, these two duck beneath the bench.

Tine leans against Tart. Tart moves a paw's width away. Tine follows.

Tart shifts again. A drop falls through the slats onto his nose.

He looks up. Another drop.

Tine has already curled into the dry patch. Tart comes back, turns once and lowers himself beside him. His chin settles across Tine's forelegs. The toy rests between their paws.

The handler crouches at the open side of the bench. She takes a photograph, then reaches in to bring them indoors.

MATCH CUT TO THE PHOTOGRAPH: the two puppies, the bench leg, the toy. A kennel archive caption beneath it identifies “Tart and Tine - Victoria, Australia.”

MONTHS LATER. The kennel keeps the same captioned puppy photograph in its archive. The puppies are bigger now. Separate handlers lead them towards two open transport crates in the covered yard.

Tine pauses beside Tart and leans. This time Tart stays still.

Their handlers allow the contact, then guide them into their own crates. Doors close without haste. The crates are secured in separate vehicles.

Tine watches through a ventilation opening. In the other vehicle, Tart's nose moves towards an opening of his own.

A vehicle turns out of the gate. The other remains. For a moment, the space between them holds only rain.

Wind over the pasture becomes wind over harbour water.

TITLE: SOMEWHERE BETWEEN US / 我們之間

02 | INT./EXT. TRAINING SETTINGS - PASSAGE OF TIME

Growing dogs, distinct paths. A few complete actions carry the months.

Tart approaches a training obstacle. The narrow gap will admit a dog but not the person beside him. He pauses, takes the wider route and clears both bodies past it. His trainer rewards him.

In a Hong Kong training practice room, Tine enters beside his handler. Blue moulded chairs and a low chair with a loose cream cushion distinguish it from the centre. His wag knocks the cushion to the floor. He goes to investigate, then notices the seated volunteer pull her hands into her lap. He stops approaching. His handler gives him space to settle.

Later: the volunteer lowers one hand. Tine offers his shoulder, keeping four paws on the floor.

In the same Hong Kong practice room, Tart meets AH MING. Ah Ming introduces his hand, strokes Tart's shoulder and waits. Tart steps closer. In a later training session, their pace falls into step.

In the same practice room, MAY sits beside Tine. He tries to put his whole front half on her lap. She redirects him to the floor. He compromises with his chin on her knee.

In the Hong Kong practice room, a staff member hands May a print of the captioned puppy photograph. She studies it, then keeps it flat in the inner pocket of her tan visiting bag. This same print will return at the centre and harbour.

MATCH CUT: Tart's young paw on a practice path becomes his adult paw on a Hong Kong doorstep.

03 | INT. AH MING'S FLAT / EXT. CENTRAL - MONDAY MORNING

In Ah Ming's compact Hong Kong flat, a radio gives the weather. Beside his oatmeal upholstered armchair, his cream cup with a teal handle rests in its usual place. He lowers the radio and checks his keys by touch. His folded white cane, with its red lower section, goes into his navy bag beside a compact recorder.

Tart lies on the floor wearing his brown collar, with no lead attached. At the small sound of the harness buckle, his head comes up.

AH MING
頭先叫你起身就聽唔到。出街就咁精神？

Ah Ming fits and checks Tart's brown guide harness. The separate collar lead stays packed away while the harness is on. Tart stands quietly; the tip of his tail does not.

AH MING
好，蛋撻。返工。

Outside, a shopping trolley blocks part of the lift doorway. Tart waits. The neighbour straightens its wheels.

NEIGHBOUR
唔好意思，等陣呀。

AH MING
唔緊要，慢慢嚟。

The way clears. They leave together.

On a Central pavement, Ah Ming chooses a recess well away from the kerb and walking line. He stops, lets the harness handle rest and takes out his recorder. Tart stands beside him.

DING-DING. A tram bell. Then a delivery trolley rattles through the recording.

AH MING
連送貨都錄埋。

He smiles, saves the short clip and puts the recorder away before taking the handle again.

A phone notification speaks from his pocket: Bo's reminder for Friday's small listening gathering. Ah Ming stops in the recess to send a brief reply.

AH MING
星期五三點，記得。我帶兩段聲嚟。

Phone away. He turns towards the sound of cups from nearby Lan Kee Cha Chaan Teng. The green canopy reads 蘭記茶餐廳.

AH MING
食早餐先。

Tart's nose lifts. He waits for the travelling cue.

04 | EXT./INT. HONG KONG - MONDAY, TWO LIVES

A distinct parallel-life montage. Match movements, then let each dog finish his own task. The rhythm grows from footsteps, cups, lift chimes and chair legs.

CENTRAL PAVEMENT. At Tart's height, shoes cross in different directions. A delivery worker turns a loaded trolley across the walking line. Tart slows, lets it pass and takes Ah Ming through the opening behind it, leaving clearance for his shoulder.

COMMUNITY CENTRE, KOWLOON, LATER THAT MORNING. Shoes also surround Tine. His attention travels upward: a smiling face, a hand patting a knee, a woman looking away. May brings him to the person who has invited him. He passes the other chair without pushing closer.

TART. A station lift opens. Ah Ming directs him forward. Tart waits for an exiting passenger and a suitcase, then enters with enough room for Ah Ming. The lift doors close on their reflection.

TINE. LOK peers around his mother's chair at a family activity in the centre. Tine tilts his head. Lok withdraws. Tine stays beside May. Lok peeks from the other side; Tine's ears swing after his turning head. A smile escapes Lok.

TART. Beneath a cream laminate table at Lan Kee, his forepaws form two straight lines. A toast corner lands nearby. His nostrils move. His paws do not. AUNTIE LAN retrieves it before a child can offer it to him.

AUNTIE LAN
佢做緊嘢，唔好餵佢。

TINE. A biscuit crumb falls beside a centre chair. His nose follows it. May gives a quiet cue; he looks up at her. Someone clears the crumb. He settles with one hind leg sticking out.

TART. An earlier moment at the same Lan Kee Cha Chaan Teng: Ah Ming pays while Tart stands clear of the doorway. Auntie Lan glances down at the harness.

AUNTIE LAN
阿華田又咁早？

AH MING
蛋撻呀，蘭姐。

AUNTIE LAN
係喎。阿May嗰隻先係阿華田。

Tart leads Ah Ming away. Hold the doorway as the light shifts slightly; an order is cleared from the outside collection shelf.

MINUTES LATER. May and Tine pass the same doorway on their way to a prearranged pet-friendly car for the Kowloon visit. Auntie Lan hands May her takeaway drink. Tart and Ah Ming have already turned out of sight.

AUNTIE LAN
今日齊晒，蛋撻阿華田。

Tine turns at her voice. His wag starts before she finishes. May smiles and takes him on.

This is the FIRST MISSED ENCOUNTER: the same doorway, a few minutes apart. Neither dog detects the other.

Back in their separate working days: Tart pauses at a narrowed pavement until an oncoming stroller clears. Tine waits while an older woman's hand slowly reaches his shoulder.

Tart moves into the space. Tine stays under the hand.

The rhythm loosens. At the far end of the centre, a newspaper rises in front of a man's face. Tine notices. His wag softens.

CUT OUT OF THE MONTAGE to the street's full, unscored sound.

05 | EXT. SIGNALLED CROSSING, CENTRAL - MONDAY, LATE MORNING

A modest crossing at a junction. Establish the complete layout before tightening: Ah Ming and Tart on the pavement; a delivery van caught across part of the crossing by a queue beyond it. The van has not cleared the pedestrian route.

Tart brings Ah Ming to the kerb and stops. Ah Ming checks his alignment and listens. Recorder in bag. No headphones.

The audible pedestrian signal changes. Through the wider traffic wash, the idling van is difficult to distinguish.

AH MING
蛋撻，行。

Tart does not step off. His forepaws remain behind the edge. His eyes follow the van's front wheel.

Ah Ming feels that no forward movement has come through the handle. He stays behind Tart rather than stepping past him.

AH MING
蛋撻？

A brake light goes out. The van creeps forward across the line they would have taken, then stops again behind the queue.

Tart holds his ground. No barking, backward yank or leap into the road.

A pedestrian draws level, ready to go around them, sees the van and stops too.

PEDESTRIAN
前面仲有架車。

Ah Ming turns his attention towards the engine. Now the van moves and its tyres make the hazard audible. He gives no further forward cue.

AH MING
知道。等佢過先。

The van clears. The crossing signal is already changing. Ah Ming elects to wait.

AH MING
唔趕。等下一轉。

His hand briefly finds Tart's shoulder. Tart looks towards him, then back to the road. Both remain in position.

A short time cut carries the ordinary wait: the opposite traffic passes; a takeaway bag rustles beside them. No triumphant score.

At the next pedestrian phase, Ah Ming listens and reassesses. He aligns himself and takes the handle.

AH MING
好，行。

This time Tart steps forward. Ah Ming follows at their established pace. They clear the crossing and stop beyond the up-kerb, out of other pedestrians' way.

AH MING
做得好。

A shoulder rub. Tart's tail answers. Ah Ming gives their next direction; they continue into the city.

06 | INT. ELDERLY NEIGHBOURHOOD CENTRE, TSIM SHA TSUI - MONDAY AFTERNOON

The same community room after the group activity. A ground-floor corner unit in Tsim Sha Tsui: glass entrance doors on the front wall; the right-hand windows face the side street, with pavement and ordinary shops beyond. Sage stackable chairs, newspaper rack, water dispenser and an empty umbrella stand. Members collect shopping bags and leave for their own homes.

UNCLE CHAN, coat folded over his chair, reads by the window. His grocery bag sits beneath the chair. May gathers Tine's mat and bowl at a respectful distance.

Tine turns towards Uncle Chan. The newspaper lifts.

UNCLE CHAN
唔使過嚟。我唔鍾意狗。

May stops. She takes a chair across the open space, leaving his exit clear.

MAY
好。我哋喺呢邊坐陣，唔過嚟。

Tine stands beside her, watching the edge of the paper. In the doorway someone says goodbye; his tail starts again. He could turn towards them. Instead he looks back at Uncle Chan, lowers himself onto the mat and exhales.

May gives him water. He drinks and settles. His body faces slightly away from the man; he is not staring him down.

Uncle Chan looks over the paper. Tine does not close the distance.

A folded flyer slips from Uncle Chan's lap. He reaches for it. Tine's head rises; one paw shifts beneath his chest.

Uncle Chan's hand stops. Tine stops too.

The man picks up the flyer himself and sits back. The dog lowers his head again.

UNCLE CHAN
佢唔使周圍走㗎？

MAY
頭先見咗好多人，佢都要休息。

UNCLE CHAN
咁都叫返工？

MAY
識得休息，都幾重要。

Uncle Chan looks at May. Then at Tine's untidy hind leg. The newspaper comes down to his lap.

UNCLE CHAN
佢叫咩話？

MAY
阿華田。

UNCLE CHAN
狗都叫阿華田。

He leaves his hand beside the chair. Tine notices but stays on the mat.

UNCLE CHAN
過嚟啦。

May checks the invitation with a glance. Uncle Chan nods. She allows Tine to approach slowly on a slack lead.

Tine stops within reach and turns his shoulder. Uncle Chan touches him, pauses, then strokes. Tine's tail moves once. His feet stay still.

BO, the centre worker, quietly indicates the time from the doorway. May begins to pack the bowl.

UNCLE CHAN
……咁快就走？

MAY
星期四再嚟。

As Tine leaves, Uncle Chan raises two fingers from his folded newspaper. Tine looks back from beside May. One last wag, then they go.

07 | INT. AH MING'S FLAT - MONDAY EVENING

Ah Ming puts his keys away, removes Tart's harness and hangs it in its place.

AH MING
收工。

Tart shakes from nose to tail. Before Ah Ming has finished sitting down, a soft squeaky toy lands against his knee. Same two-ended shape as the puppy toy, a newer one.

AH MING
等我飲啖水先啦。

Ah Ming drinks. Tart transfers the toy to the other knee.

A sip. SQUEAK.

Ah Ming sets the glass safely on the side table and reaches out.

Tart lets him find one end, then plants his feet. A determined, beautifully controlled tug. Ah Ming gives a little ground. Tart gives none.

AH MING
你真係唔客氣喎。

Ah Ming lets go. Tart backs into a floor cushion and sits abruptly on it. He looks around at the offending cushion, toy still in his mouth.

Ah Ming hears the soft thump and laughs. Tart brings the toy straight back, pressing it into his hand.

Later, Ah Ming trims his two short recordings while seated. Headphones on. Tart is not responding to sounds only Ah Ming can hear: he watches the moving hand, nudges it once and receives an absent-minded ear rub.

Tart curls beside the chair. He lays the toy across his forepaws, then shifts his flank towards Ah Ming's foot until they touch.

The hand comes down and stays.

08 | EXT. TSIM SHA TSUI STATION STREET EXIT / INT. CENTRE - THURSDAY AFTERNOON

A clearly established public pavement outside an MTR street exit. May and Tine are walking to the nearby centre; they do not enter railway premises.

Tart and Ah Ming emerge from the station. Ah Ming pauses in a clear space to orient himself, then directs Tart along the pavement.

Beyond the solid side wall of the exit, Tine investigates a leaf caught at the base of a public bench. May waits for him to look up.

The two routes run within several metres of each other. From above we can read both; at dog height the wall blocks the view.

Tart's ear turns towards the small scrape of Tine's collar against the bench. He maintains his line beside Ah Ming.

Tine lifts his head. By the time May and Tine round the wall, Tart and Ah Ming have passed into the next stream of pedestrians. A cream coat is briefly visible between two legs, then gone.

SECOND MISSED ENCOUNTER: seconds and a wall, rather than minutes. No recognition yet.

May checks the time and continues to the centre. Tine takes one last look back, then follows willingly.

Inside, Uncle Chan glances at the clock. Moves his grocery bag from the adjoining chair to the floor. Takes a newspaper, but does not open it.

Tine appears in the doorway. His tail taps an empty umbrella stand. CLONG. He turns to inspect the sound. Silence. Turns back. CLONG.

May moves the stand out of reach.

From the window chair:

UNCLE CHAN
阿華田。

Tine turns sharply, wagging from the ribs back. He starts forward, notices Uncle Chan lowering himself into the chair and eases his pace.

UNCLE CHAN
呢邊。

May brings him alongside. The man's hand is already waiting.

09 | INT. ELDERLY NEIGHBOURHOOD CENTRE - THURSDAY, CONTINUOUS

Tine stands under Uncle Chan's hand, eyes half-closed. Lok watches from beside his mother.

LOK
佢記得你呀。

UNCLE CHAN
你都記得佢啦。

May spreads Tine's sage mat. As she takes the toy from her bag, she brings out the captioned puppy print to keep it from bending. Lok spots the two puppies beneath the bench.

LOK
呢隻細嘅係佢？

MAY
係呀。犬舍俾返我留念嘅。

May points to Tine's heart-shaped marking in the print. Tart lies beside him; the archive caption remains below the picture. She returns the print to her bag before the conversation can become an investigation.

Tine offers Uncle Chan the toy, then picks it up just before the man can take it. Puts it down. Uncle Chan reaches. Up it comes again.

UNCLE CHAN
你究竟俾唔俾我㗎？

May waits. Tine finally leaves it in his hand.

A small SQUEAK. Tine bows, hindquarters high. Lok laughs and steps from behind his mother's chair.

LOK
我可唔可以摸吓佢？

MAY
可以。等佢坐定先。

Tine settles. May guides Lok to stroke his shoulder, then lets the child withdraw when he has had enough.

Uncle Chan takes a worn photograph from his wallet: his younger self, his wife and a yellow village dog at their doorway.

UNCLE CHAN
以前嗰隻叫阿黃。成條巷養嘅。

MAY
佢都咁鍾意玩？

UNCLE CHAN
鍾意搶拖鞋。落雨就淨係識嚟我屋企。

His thumb smooths a bent corner of the photograph.

UNCLE CHAN
我太太會喺門口留條毛巾。

May leaves the silence alone. Tine lowers his chin against the man's shoe.

Bo places Saturday's harbour-outing flyer on the table. May looks at Uncle Chan.

MAY
星期六我同阿華田都去。你一齊呀？

UNCLE CHAN
睇吓先。

He puts the photograph away. The flyer goes into the same pocket.

10 | INT. ELDERLY NEIGHBOURHOOD CENTRE - FRIDAY AFTERNOON

Six sage stackable chairs and a small charcoal cylindrical speaker. No stage. Ah Ming sits beside Bo with Tart settled beneath his chair, away from feet. Tart wears his working harness and collar, with no collar lead attached. May and Tine have no visit today.

Lok and his mother have joined after school. Uncle Chan sits near the window, turning the outing flyer over in his hands.

AH MING
兩段聲，估吓喺邊度。

He presses a familiar control. The tram bell plays through the small speaker, followed by the delivery trolley.

LOK
叮叮！後面嗰架呢？

AH MING
送貨車。佢自己行入嚟㗎。

A small laugh. Tart lifts one ear at the rattle, then rests it again.

AH MING
呢段呢？

A short recording from an earlier ferry trip: water against the pier, a ferry horn, the hollow shuffle of arriving feet. The room becomes quiet enough to hear the tiny speaker's limits.

UNCLE CHAN
天星。

AH MING
係。

Ah Ming stops playback before answering him.

UNCLE CHAN
以前喺碼頭做嘢，日日聽。

He rubs the edge of the flyer. Tart changes position beneath the chair, a collar ring ticking softly against the chair leg. Uncle Chan looks down.

LOK
佢返屋企都咁乖？

AH MING
返到去就搶我玩具。

Lok looks again at the very composed dog. His mother smiles.

BO
陳伯，聽日去海旁，你想唔想一齊？

UNCLE CHAN
我太太走咗之後，好耐冇去喇。

Bo leaves the choice with him. Ah Ming does not fill the pause. Tart sighs beneath the chair.

UNCLE CHAN
阿華田都去，係咪？

BO
係，阿May帶佢嚟。

Uncle Chan smooths the flyer flat against his knee.

UNCLE CHAN
咁幫我報名啦。

Bo writes his name on the small attendance list, without ceremony.

AH MING
我聽日搭船過嚟，喺海旁等你哋。

BO
好，照約好嗰個位。散場前我再同大家講返集合時間。

Lok leans to get another look at Tart, but keeps his hands to himself. Under the chair, Tart's sleeping paw gives one small twitch.

11 | INT. UNCLE CHAN'S FLAT / EXT. CENTRE - FRIDAY EVENING / SATURDAY AFTERNOON

Uncle Chan unlocks his own front door. Groceries on the kitchen counter; his cream-and-teal electric kettle switches on. An ordinary Hong Kong home: dark wooden dining chairs, a russet sofa and a framed photograph of his wife beside the dining table.

He takes a sunhat from a cupboard and brushes its brim. Checks his navy canvas tote: water, tissues, wallet. The harbour flyer lies beside it.

Bo's confirmation comes by phone.

BO (PHONE)
聽日一點，中心集合。行边咗就坐吓。

UNCLE CHAN
記得。我個帽都搵返出嚟喇。

He hangs up and returns to making dinner.

CUT TO SATURDAY. The same hat comes through the centre's glass doorway at its step-free corner entrance on his head.

Tine stands beside May, already ready. He begins an exuberant greeting, then waits while Uncle Chan puts his bag down.

UNCLE CHAN
你又早過我。

A hand reaches his shoulder. Tine leans just enough to meet it.

12 | EXT. CENTRE / INT. STAR FERRY / EXT. HARBOUR APPROACH - SATURDAY AFTERNOON

Bo checks the small group against the attendance list. Lok stays with his mother. Another centre colleague accompanies the remaining members.

BO
我哋行去海旁。想休息就出聲，唔趕嘅。

May clips Tine's water bowl to her bag and checks his lead. The group sets off along its planned short walking route from the Tsim Sha Tsui centre.

CUT TO THE FERRY FROM CENTRAL. Ah Ming sits on a bench seat. Tart lies close at his feet, away from the aisle, working harness still on. Ah Ming's bag is closed. It is bright afternoon. The green-and-cream ferry carries passengers and crew; all practical lights are off. Tart's collar has no attached lead.

A child across the aisle asks his parent about Tart, then addresses Ah Ming.

CHILD
可唔可以摸吓佢？

AH MING
佢而家做緊嘢。等佢放工先，好唔好？

CHILD
咁……早晨，蛋撻。

AH MING
呢個可以。

The parent smiles at the afternoon greeting. Tart opens one eye, then settles as the ferry approaches the pier.

On land, Tine walks alongside Uncle Chan. A leaf skitters across their path. Tine follows it with his nose, then matches the man's pace again.

Bo phones Ah Ming. He answers while still seated aboard the moored ferry, waiting for the gangway to be ready.

BO (PHONE)
我哋過緊嚟海旁。

AH MING
我都到喇。一陣見。

Phone away. When disembarkation begins, Ah Ming takes the handle and gives the cue. Tart leads towards the exit with the other passengers.

13 | EXT. TSIM SHA TSUI STAR FERRY PUBLIC FORECOURT - CONTINUOUS

Establish the junction of two public pedestrian routes: arriving passengers coming out of the terminal; the centre group crossing the forecourt towards the promenade. Tine remains outside the terminal throughout.

Beyond both routes lies the promenade. Their agreed meeting place is farther east; a nearer inland seating bay will become important.

Tart and Ah Ming come along the terminal exit. May and Tine approach across the forecourt with the centre group. For the first time, both dogs occupy one wide frame, only a few metres apart.

A ferry horn. Tine turns one ear. Tart's head lifts slightly.

The group pauses to let arriving passengers through. Tine can see between two suitcases: a cream shoulder, the edge of a brown harness.

He takes a small step, lead still slack. May stops with him rather than pulling.

Tart briefly turns his nose towards Tine's side of the flow. A passing passenger stops to adjust a case. Tart must now wait, keeping room for Ah Ming.

The gap closes. A handful of travellers passes between the dogs.

BO
呢邊，行過少少先有位坐。

The group resumes. May and Tine follow, angling into the nearer seating bay as Bo offers a water break.

The suitcase moves. Ah Ming gives his direction towards the agreed meeting place. Tart completes the safe exit and takes him along the main promenade path, passing the screened side of the nearer bay.

Tine looks back through the gap between people. Too late. Tart is facing forward again.

THIRD MISSED ENCOUNTER: close enough for a fleeting sensory response, never a confirmed recognition. No chase. Neither handler has noticed the other dog.

From above, the separation is simple: one pair continues east along the path; the other has turned a few metres inland to rest.

Cut to Tine watching May set his water bowl down. He drinks.

14 | EXT. NEARER PROMENADE SEATING BAY - CONTINUOUS

A broad, level seating area set inland from the harbour railing. The walking route passes its entrance. The group sits; the second centre worker distributes water.

Tine finishes drinking. His ears lift; his skin begins the first ripple of a shake.

May moves him into a clear patch. Lok, beside his mother, steps back in anticipation.

LOK
唔好掏過嚟呀。

Tine shakes. One drop reaches Lok's shoe. Uncle Chan offers a tissue. Lok wipes it with exaggerated care. Uncle Chan almost laughs.

Bo checks that everyone is comfortable and prepares to continue to the original meeting point. People shift on the fixed benches; bags go over shoulders.

Uncle Chan looks across the harbour. A ferry horn, fuller than the little speaker's version. His smile fades. His hand rests against the wallet in his bag, then stays there.

May rises. Tine rises with her, ready for the group. One step towards the path.

Behind him, Uncle Chan has not stood.

Tine turns. The hand that was stroking him is closed on the bag strap. His wag slows. He steps back towards the bench and stops within the slack of his lead.

May notices and stops too.

UNCLE CHAN
我喺呢度坐吓先。你哋行住。

MAY
好，我哋陪你坐陣。

She sits. Tine lowers himself beside Uncle Chan's shoe. He does not paw at him or demand a response.

The man loosens his grip. His hand drops beside the bench. Tine turns his shoulder into reach, then becomes still.

Uncle Chan strokes him once. Stops. Begins again at his own pace.

The others remain comfortably nearby. Bo asks the group if they would rather meet Ah Ming here. Nods. The second worker takes a seat with the members.

Bo steps to the bay entrance, keeping everyone in view, and calls Ah Ming.

BO (PHONE)
明哥，我哋喺近碼頭嗰個休息位坐低咗。你到邊？

AH MING (PHONE)
到咗原本約嗰度。要返轉頭？

BO
係，沿原路返嚟。我喺入口等你。

AH MING (PHONE)
好，你企定。我到附近叫你。

Bo stays at the entrance. May caps the bottle. The group has a new meeting place because Tine turned back and May listened.

Uncle Chan looks down at the dog beside his shoe. His hand lies open on Tine's shoulder.

15 | EXT. PROMENADE PATH TO SEATING BAY - CONTINUOUS

Ah Ming finishes the call while stationary beside the original meeting bench. He pockets the phone, orients himself and directs Tart back along their familiar approach.

AH MING
蛋撻，返嗰邊。

Tart turns with him. They travel at their usual pace.

At the entrance to the nearer bay, a stroller and a parked suitcase leave an opening too narrow for both dog and person. Tart stops instead of squeezing through alone.

Ah Ming feels the stop. Ahead, Bo calls from the entrance.

BO
明哥，呢度。

AH MING
阿寶，入口係咪有嘢？

Bo sees the obstruction. She asks the suitcase's owner to move it. The stroller continues along the path. Nobody takes Ah Ming's arm or grabs Tart's harness.

BO
而家闊返，入面有位。

Ah Ming gives the direction and forward cue. Tart assesses the wider opening and guides him through, clearing Ah Ming's shoulder past the suitcase.

Inside, Tine lifts his head. Tart's nose turns towards him. A single movement of his tail, then he returns to the route Ah Ming has asked for.

AH MING
有狗喺度？

MAY
係，阿華田。我拖住佢，你坐低先。

May keeps Tine beside Uncle Chan, leaving the approach clear.

BO
張凳喺你前面，向右少少。

Ah Ming directs the final approach. Tart stops beside the bench. Ah Ming locates the seat with his hand and sits securely. The task is complete.

AH MING
做得好。

Tine stands, but waits with May. Uncle Chan lifts his hand to let him go.

Ah Ming remains seated and keeps Tart close with a calm hand at his shoulder. He removes the working harness completely and places it safely beside him, its handle folded down. Only then does he clip the separate brown lead to Tart's collar D-ring and take the lead loop securely in his hand. The collar lead was not attached while the harness was on.

CLICK.

AH MING
收工。

Tart shakes. Tine's tail gives a small, tentative answer.

16 | EXT. PROMENADE SEATING BAY, VICTORIA HARBOUR - CONTINUOUS

May remains a few steps away, Tine beside her. Ah Ming keeps Tart close on a loose lead.

MAY
俾佢哋打個招呼，好唔好？

AH MING
好呀，慢慢嚟。

The handlers allow a curved approach in the open patch in front of their seats. Two slack leads remain separate. No other dog joins them.

Tine stops short of Tart. His nose stretches forward. Tart takes one measured step.

They sniff along shoulder and neck, then separate by half a step. Tine's tail pauses. Tart's mouth softens.

No flashback. Hold the two adult bodies long enough for their small adjustments to be visible.

Tine leans. Tart shifts away.

Tine starts to follow, then stops himself. He stands in the little space Tart has left, looking towards May. The eager dog knows how to wait now.

Tart looks back at him.

May sits, reaches into her bag and brings out Tine's familiar two-ended toy. Tine takes it. A soft SQUEAK.

Tart's ears lift. Tine holds still, the toy hanging from his mouth.

Tart steps closer. Touches its free end with his nose.

Tine lowers it. Tart takes hold.

A brief, gentle tug, contained between the handlers. Tart braces with the same neat stance he had beneath the bench. Tine adjusts one paw. Then another. Sits by accident.

The toy comes free into Tart's mouth.

Tine looks up. His tail sweeps once across the paving.

Tart holds his prize. Then, without a prompt, brings the other end back.

Tine rises into a broad play bow. Tart answers with his smaller one. The two shapes finally fit the memory the audience has carried since the beginning.

A few light paw steps, no circling. Their shoulders bump. Tine's inside-out ear briefly stays folded; Tart noses it as they break apart. Tine shakes it back into place.

Ah Ming hears the squeak and the shuffling paws.

AH MING
蛋撻肯分玩具呀？

MAY
係呀。仲拎返俾佢。

AH MING
平時都唔肯俾我。

A small laugh. It does not interrupt the dogs.

May watches Tine lean towards Tart again. Recognition crosses her own face now. She takes out the same captioned puppy print we saw at the centre and reads the archive names.

MAY
等陣……你隻叫Tart？

AH MING
係呀，蛋撻。

MAY
犬舍俾我嗰張相，寫住 Tart同 Tine。澳洲 Victoria嗰個犬舍。

AH MING
蛋撻都係嗰度嚟。

May looks from the clear archive names and familiar puppy markings to the dogs in front of her. She turns towards Ah Ming to describe the picture.

MAY
兩隻瞓喺張凳底。蛋撻個頭，搭住阿華田隻腳。

Ah Ming's hand reaches Tart's back. He feels the dog standing relaxed beneath it.

AH MING
原來細個就識。

May returns the print to her bag. The photograph has confirmed what the dogs have already shown.

Beside them, Bo quietly checks Uncle Chan's return preference as part of checking the group. Uncle Chan watches the dogs, his hat loose in his hands.

UNCLE CHAN
我想坐多陣。

BO
好，我哋一陣一齊返。

Uncle Chan makes room on the bench for Lok and his mother. No speech, no photograph passed around, no separate resolution.

On the ground, Tine sits close to Tart and leans. Tart moves a fraction. Tine follows a fraction, then waits.

Tart glances at the empty space on his other side. He could take it.

Instead he shifts his forepaws, opening room beside his chest. Tine folds down into it.

Tart lowers himself alongside. Their shoulders meet. The toy lies between their paws, as it did beneath the bench.

Tart rests his chin across Tine's forelegs.

AH MING
瞓低咗？

MAY
係。貼住一齊。

Ah Ming leaves his hand lightly on Tart's back. May's hand rests near Tine. Neither asks anything of them.

The last trace of music eases into the live harbour: water, a distant horn, people passing. Tine's tail moves once. Tart's paw relaxes against his.

Widen just enough to hold the dogs, their people and the harbour beyond. The world keeps moving. They have found a place beside each other.

FADE OUT.

END TITLE: From Victoria to Victoria Harbour.

END.

PRODUCTION CONTINUITY

Visual continuity

Warm Pixar-like stylized 3D, rounded shapes and tactile materials throughout. Hong Kong details sit within this style. The selected sheets in this folder are the visual masters; earlier folders and drafts are superseded.

Locations

Lan Kee stays in Central. The centre is a ground-floor corner unit in Tsim Sha Tsui with a front glass entrance and street-facing side windows. No duplicate centre opposite its windows. Ah Ming's flat has a plain wooden door and no internal gate. The Australian puppy yard and guide-training path stay in Victoria; the practice room and handler introductions are in Hong Kong.

Furniture and props

Centre: sage stackables and separate wooden window armchair. Ah Ming: oatmeal upholstered armchair and mustard cushion. Lan Kee: red vinyl, chrome and cream laminate, green-striped cups. Practice room: blue moulded chairs and loose cream cushion. Uncle Chan: dark wooden furniture, russet sofa, cream/teal electric kettle and navy tote. Ferry: teak slat benches. Harbour: stone-based bay benches and a separate curved meeting bench.

Time and transport

Monday: scenes03-07. Thursday: scenes08-09. Friday: scene10 and scene11 home. Saturday: scene11 centre through scene16. Listening Friday15:00; outing gathers Saturday13:00. Use the morning centre plate for scene04 and the afternoon plate for scenes06/08/09/10; advance clock hands within shots as time passes. The exterior departure clock is13:00. All scene12 ferry views are afternoon, lights off, passengers and crew present. Road vehicles in use have drivers. May and Tine use the prearranged pet-friendly car for their Kowloon visit.

Public routes

Tine stays on public pavement outside the MTR and outside the ferry terminal. Ah Ming and Tart arrive by ferry. The public forecourt shows two pedestrian streams; the nearer bay is inland from the rail, while the original meeting bench is farther east. Fictionalised film geography is consistent across the supplied views.

Crossing

Van already occupies part of crossing, queued behind blue car. Tart and Ah Ming stay behind kerb while it clears. They wait for a fresh pedestrian phase. Ah Ming chooses directions; Tart judges immediate obstacles. No headphones while travelling.

Harness transition

No collar lead during harness work. At scene15, Ah Ming sits securely, removes harness, folds handle safely, THEN clips the separate brown lead to collar D-ring and holds the loop. May holds Tine's separate orange lead. During greeting and tug, both leads stay slack, separate and held.

The two photographs

Use the SAME canonical puppy print in scenes01,02,09,16, without redrawing it. Caption: Tart and Tine - Victoria, Australia. It confirms childhood companionship only after behavioural recognition. No sibling claim, scanning app or microchip reveal. Uncle Chan's wife-and-Ah-Wong photograph is a different picture; retain its established image.

Sound and performance

Dogs never speak or narrate. Only two recorded clips at the centre: tram/delivery trolley and an earlier ferry recording. Final harbour sound is live. Keep greetings, play and recognition observable, unforced and brief.

Asset use

The pack contains finished raster design sheets, clean environment plates and populated staging references. Multi-view sheets are references, not one continuous camera shot. Use scene mappings for placement. Clean backgrounds receive the character and vehicle assets as required by each shot.

Timing and credits

Story target approximately 20 minutes before credits; shot timing remains an editorial/animatic task. Based on the original story outline by Irene Chan. This continuity revision preserves the 16-scene story and Cantonese dialogue except the photograph-prop clarification.